

Makoya Widget — Feature Comparison vs Competitors

Makoya

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Makoya Widget — Feature Comparison vs. Competitors

Prepared: 2026-06-30 **Scope:** Every end-user feature in the Makoya accessibility widget — both what is **live in production today** and what is **being built now** on the `feat/widget-accessible-parity` branch — set side-by-side against the four leading accessibility-overlay vendors: **accessiBe**, **UserWay**, **AudioEye**, and **EqualWeb**.

1. Executive summary

- After the in-flight **accessiBe-parity build** lands, the Makoya widget exposes **35 user-facing tools**, **12 one-click profiles**, and **4 UI languages** (en / es / fr / de).
 - On the *visible tool menu*, Makoya reaches **full accessiBe parity** and goes **beyond it** on profiles (12 vs 6) and on several toggles (bigger tap targets, page zoom, voice navigation + virtual keyboard together, AI text-simplify).
 - The competitors' remaining differentiation is **not** in the panel — it is the background **"AI automatic remediation / screen-reader optimization"** layer plus **legal compliance guarantees**. Makoya **deliberately does not build these** (architectural invariant: never rewrite the host DOM; compliance-copy guardrail). This is the exact behaviour that produced lawsuits and disability-community backlash against the overlays.
 - The one honest, closable gap is **UI language coverage** (4 vs 12–50+). It is translation work, not engineering.
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2. Build status legend

Mark	Meaning
 LIVE	Shipped and running in production today (the 18-feature bundle).
 IN BUILD	Being built now on <code>feat/widget-accessible-parity</code> (target state: 35 features).
	Competitor has the feature
	Competitor has a partial / weaker version
	Competitor does not have it
	Deliberately excluded by Makoya (by design — see §5)

3. Makoya's complete feature set (post-parity)

CONTENT ADJUSTMENTS (10)

#	Feature	Status	Notes
1	Page zoom (whole-page 70–150%)	 IN BUILD	zoom on body; reflows, unlike transform-scale
2	Text size (80–200% stepper)	 LIVE →  upgraded to % stepper	Root font-size scaling (rem/em safe)
3	Line spacing (100–250%)	 LIVE →  % stepper	
4	Letter spacing (0–0.5em)	 IN BUILD	New continuous control
5	Readable / dyslexia font	 LIVE →  segmented (off/readable/dyslexic)	OpenDyslexic embed in parallel branch
6	Text alignment (L/C/R/justify)	 LIVE →  5-button segment	
7	Highlight titles	 LIVE	Yellow chip on headings
8	Highlight links	 LIVE	Underline + outline
9	Hide images	 LIVE	Reduces distraction
10	Stop animations	 LIVE	Pauses motion/autoplay

COLOR / DISPLAY (6)

#	Feature	Status	Notes
11	Contrast modes (on/light/dark/high)	● LIVE (on/dark) →  add light + high	Composed body-filter seam
12	Saturation (grayscale/low/high)	● LIVE	
13	Text color override	 IN BUILD	Curated swatch palette
14	Title color override	 IN BUILD	Curated swatch palette
15	Background color override	 IN BUILD	Curated swatch palette
16	Reading mask	● LIVE	Dims page around a focus band

ORIENTATION / NAVIGATION (12)

#	Feature	Status	Notes
17	Reading ruler	● LIVE	Guide line follows cursor
18	Big cursor (black / white)	● LIVE	
19	Highlight on hover	● LIVE	Outlines element under pointer
20	Bigger tap targets	● LIVE	≥44px hit areas (beyond accessiBe)
21	Enhanced focus ring	● LIVE	Bold amber <code>:focus-visible</code> ring
22	Text magnifier lens	🔨 IN BUILD	Pointer-driven overlay
23	Reading mode (article view)	🔨 IN BUILD	Distraction-free Shadow-DOM pane, focus-trapped
24	Useful links menu	🔨 IN BUILD	Jump menu of page links
25	Page structure menu	🔨 IN BUILD	Headings / landmarks jump menu
26	Keyboard navigation shortcuts	🔨 IN BUILD	Modifier-gated (Alt+M/H/F/B/G)
27	Virtual keyboard	🔨 IN BUILD	On-screen keyboard (UserWay parity)
28	Voice navigation	🔨 IN BUILD	SpeechRecognition commands (UserWay parity)

AUDIO (2)

#	Feature	Status	Notes
29	Mute sounds	● LIVE	
30	Read aloud (TTS)	● LIVE	Click-to-speak

CHROME / TOOLS (5)

#	Feature	Status	Notes
31	Dictionary lookup	 IN BUILD	<code>dictionaryapi.dev</code> , client-side, fail-silent
32	Feedback form	 IN BUILD	POST <code>/api/widget-feedback</code> → owner email
33	Hide interface (session)	 LIVE	Restores next page-load
34	In-panel user guide	 IN BUILD	"Help" (compliance-safe naming)
35	AI text simplify	 IN BUILD (ships OFF)	Per-site flag, Claude Haiku, never rewrites host DOM

ONE-CLICK PROFILES (12 — ACCESSIBLE HAS 6)

Vision impaired · Low vision · Dyslexia · ADHD / Focus · Seizure safe · Senior · Cognitive · Color blind · Motor / tremor · ESL / Easy reading · Keyboard navigation · Clear reading

LANGUAGES (4)

English · Spanish · French · German

4. Head-to-head comparison matrix

Feature	Makoya	accessiBe	UserWay	AudioEye	EqualWeb
— Content —					
Page zoom (whole page)					
Text size scaling					
Line spacing					
Letter spacing					
Readable / dyslexia font					
Text alignment					
Highlight titles					
Highlight links					
Hide images					
Stop animations					
— Color / Display —					
Contrast (dark/light/high)	 / 				
Saturation (mono/low/high)					
Text color override					
Title color override					
Background color override					
Reading mask					
— Navigation / Motor —					
Reading ruler / guide					

Feature	Makoya	accessiBe	UserWay	AudioEye	EqualWeb
Big cursor (B/W)	●	✓	✓	✓	✓
Highlight on hover	●	✓	⚠	✓	✓
Bigger tap targets	●	✗	✗	✗	⚠
Enhanced focus ring	●	✓	✓	✓	✓
Text magnifier lens	🔧	✓	⚠	⚠	✓
Reading mode (article view)	🔧	✓	⚠	⚠	✓
Useful links menu	🔧	✓	⚠	⚠	✓
Page structure / landmarks	🔧	⚠	✓	✓	✓
Keyboard navigation shortcuts	🔧	✓	✓	✓	✓
Virtual keyboard	🔧	✓	✗	✗	⚠
Voice navigation	🔧	✗	✓	⚠	✗
— Audio —					
Mute sounds	●	✓	⚠	⚠	✓
Read aloud / TTS	●	⚠	✓	✓	✓
— Tools / Chrome —					
Dictionary lookup	🔧	✓	✓	⚠	✓
Feedback form	🔧	✓	✓	✓	✓
Hide interface (session)	●	✓	✓	✓	✓
In-panel user guide / help	🔧	⚠	⚠	⚠	⚠
AI text simplify	🔧	✗	⚠	✗	✗

Feature	Makoya	accessiBe	UserWay	AudioEye	EqualWeb
— Presets / Locale —					
One-click profiles	12	6	~4		~6
UI languages	4	12+	50+	many	many

5. Features competitors have that Makoya does NOT

These are the only meaningful gaps. The first two are **deliberate refusals**, not missing work.

5.1 DELIBERATELY EXCLUDED (BY DESIGN)

1. **AI “automatic remediation” / screen-reader optimization.** accessiBe, UserWay, and AudioEye inject ARIA roles, auto-generate alt-text, and rewrite the page DOM in the background to claim screen-reader support. **Makoya refuses this** — its core invariant is *effects via CSS attributes + one stylesheet, never DOM rewriting, never fighting the user’s assistive tech*. This refusal is the heart of Makoya’s positioning: it is precisely the behaviour that triggered ADA lawsuits and a [public statement against overlays signed by accessibility advocates].
2. **”WCAG/ADA compliant in 48 hours” guarantees.** Competitors lead with legal-compliance claims. Makoya’s compliance guardrail forbids this copy — the widget offers accessibility *preferences/tools*, never a compliance guarantee. A go-to-market choice, not a missing feature.

5.2 GENUINE, CLOSABLE GAPS

3. **UI language coverage** — competitors localize the *panel UI* into 12–50+ languages; Makoya ships 4. This is translation-string work (`i18n.ts`), not engineering; the type system already supports adding languages.
4. **Managed / human remediation services** (AudioEye, EqualWeb) — human audits + remediation sold as a service. A services business line, adjacent to (not part of) the widget. Makoya’s scanner is the comparable asset.

5. **Vendor scale extras** — usage-analytics dashboards, automated accessibility-statement generators, litigation-support/monitoring. Makoya has some adjacent (scanner, statement generator in v3.1 backend); others are unbuilt.
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6. Features Makoya has that competitors do NOT (or do worse)

1. **Bigger tap targets** — ≥ 44 px motor-friendly hit areas; absent from accessiBe and UserWay.
 2. **12 one-click profiles vs accessiBe's 6** — adds Color-blind, Motor/tremor, ESL, Cognitive, Clear-reading on top of full parity.
 3. **Voice navigation + virtual keyboard together** — UserWay has voice; accessiBe has neither voice nav nor the combo.
 4. **AI text simplification** — genuinely rare among overlays; ships OFF behind a per-site plan flag.
 5. **Whole-page zoom** (true reflow) rather than font-scale only.
 6. **A widget that is itself accessible** — real `<button>`s, `aria-pressed`, Esc-to-close, focus management, Shadow-DOM isolation, and prefs that persist across SPA navigation. Competitor overlays are frequently criticized for failing exactly here.
 7. **Fail-open architecture** — every network/storage/permission path is guarded; the widget never throws and never blocks the host page.
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7. Bottom line

Dimension	Verdict
Visible tool menu	Parity+ — meets accessiBe, exceeds UserWay/AudioEye defaults
One-click profiles	Ahead — 12 vs 6
Unique tools	Bigger targets, page zoom, voice + virtual keyboard, AI simplify
Background AI remediation	Intentionally absent (legal/ethical stance, not a gap)
Compliance guarantees	Intentionally absent (guardrail)
Language coverage	Behind — 4 vs 12–50+ (closable: translation only)
Self-accessibility & safety	Ahead — overlays routinely fail here

Net: once the parity build ships, Makoya matches or beats the competitors on everything a visitor can actually see and use, while deliberately declining the one capability (background “auto-compliance” DOM rewriting) that has made the incumbents legally and reputationally vulnerable.